

Colton D. Tinsley

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Education

Doctor of Philosophy, Criminology and Criminal Justice

August 2026 - Present

University of Nebraska at Omaha

GPA: TBD

Master of Arts, Criminology & Criminal Justice

August 2024 - May 2026

University of Nebraska at Omaha

GPA: 3.8

Thesis: *Lessons Learned from Loss: Comparing the Behavioral Pathways between Perpetrators of Mass and School Shootings*

Chair: Dr. Jessica Deitzer

Committee Member: Dr. Sadaf Hashimi

External Reader: Dr. Charity Evans

Bachelor of Arts, Criminal Justice

August 2020 - December 2023

Michigan State University

GPA: 3.1

Majors: Criminal Justice, Political Science

Minor: Law, Justice, and Public Policy

Professional Education and Development

College of Public Affairs and Community Service

February 2026

University of Nebraska at Omaha

12 Analytics

Certificate for Completion of 16 Hours of Professional Education Focused on AI and Policing

Research Interests

Gun violence prevention, mass and school shootings, youth violence, violence prevention strategies, behavioral pathways to violence, adolescent decision-making, police efficacy

Research Experience

University of Nebraska at Omaha

Graduate Research Assistant

- [Violence Intervention and Policing Research \(VIPR\) Lab](#) under the supervision of Drs. Justin Nix, Sadaf Hashimi, and Travis Carter
 - August 2024 - Present
- Project Safe Neighborhoods (PSN) under the supervision of Dr. Justin Nix
 - May 2025 - September 2025
- Graduate Assistantship under the supervision of Dr. Jessica Deitzer
 - August 2024 - Present

Scholarship

Working Papers and Other Publications

Tinsley, C. & Deitzer, J. (forthcoming). *Untangling the Link between Social Isolation and Violence: The Role of Alienation*.

Nix, J., **Tinsley, C.**, Cline, J. (2025). *Final Report for PSN Omaha: FY2022: Violent Gang and Gun Crime Reduction*.

Grants

University of Nebraska at Omaha Office of Research Creative Activity (ORCA) Grant, \$500. *Untangling the Link between Social Isolation and Violence: The Role of Alienation*. American Society of Criminology's Annual Meeting (2025). Work completed under the supervision of Dr. Jessica Deitzer

Conference Participation

Presentations

Tinsley, C. *Behavioral Pathways to Violence: A Comparative Analysis of Mass and School Shooters*. (forthcoming November 2026). 81st Annual Meeting of the American Society of Criminology: Chicago, IL.

Tinsley, C., Cline, J., Bruha, A. *The Missing Data on Canicide: Understanding Police Shootings of Dogs*. (forthcoming November 2026). 81st Annual Meeting of the American Society of Criminology: Chicago, IL.

Tinsley, C. & Deitzer, J. November 2025. *Untangling the Link between Social Isolation and Violence: The Role of Alienation*. 80th Annual Meeting of the American Society of Criminology: Washington, D.C.

Nix, J., Hashimi, S., Cline, J., **Tinsley, C.**, & Ditter, L. *Challenging Police Killings Data*. November 2025. 80th Meeting of the American Society of Criminology: Washington, D.C.

Teaching Experience

Graduate Assistant

August 2024 - Present

- CRCJ 3350: Criminological Theory (Fall 2024, Fall 2026), under the supervision of Dr. Jessica Deitzer

Guest Lecture

- CRCJ 4080-002: Special Problems in Criminal Justice: Juvenile Reentry in the Facility (Spring 2026), under the supervision of Sadie Brewer

Service

Professional

American Society of Criminology

November 2025

Session Chair: The Impact of Social Bonds on Delinquency

University

Treasurer

August 2025 - Present

Association of Blacks and Browns in Criminal Justice

- School of Criminology and Criminal Justice, at the University of Nebraska at Omaha

Graduate Student Organization

August 2026 - Present

- School of Criminology and Criminal Justice, at the University of Nebraska at Omaha

Professional Affiliation

American Society of Criminology

November 2025 - Present

References

Available upon request